PEARSON EDEXCEL GCSE (9–1) HISTORY MARK SCHEME

2019 Exam-Style Practice Paper

Paper 3: Conflict at Home and Abroad: the USA, 1954–75 (1HI0/33)

Question 1: Inference from Source A (4 Marks)

Target: AO3 (4 marks). Award 1 mark for each valid inference, up to 2. Award 1 mark for each corresponding quote/detail, up to 2.

Sample Acceptable Inferences (the situation at Central High School, Little Rock, in September 1957):

• **Inference 1:** The local municipal police were completely unable to control the violent mob outside the school.

- *Detail from source:* "A hostile crowd of more than a thousand protesters has gathered outside the high school... Municipal police forces are insufficient to maintain order."

• **Inference 2:** The state governor was deliberately obstructing desegregation and refusing to protect the students.

- *Detail from source:* "The governor has declined to intervene and appears to condone the obstruction. We cannot guarantee the safety of the Black students."

Question 2: Causal Explanation (12 Marks)

Target: AO1/AO2 (12 marks). Level 4 (10–12 marks): An analytical explanation showing a line of reasoning with clear links to the outcome, supported by accurate, detailed knowledge.

"One reason why US involvement in the Vietnam War changed under President Nixon was the implementation of Vietnamisation to withdraw US troops." Under the **Nixon Doctrine**, Nixon began the systematic withdrawal of US ground troops, reducing forces from over 500,000 to under 25,000 by 1972, while training the South Vietnamese army. This policy was designed to appease domestic anti-war sentiment by reducing US casualties. *Therefore, Vietnamisation was a primary cause of why US involvement in the Vietnam War changed under President Nixon because it marked the transition of the US role from active ground combat to an advisory and supportive capacity.*

"A second reason why US involvement in the Vietnam War changed under President Nixon was that intense domestic anti-war protests and political pressure forced a change in policy." Events like the exposure of the **My Lai Massacre** in 1969, the **Kent State** shootings in 1970, and the leaking of the **Pentagon Papers** in 1971 destroyed public trust. The resulting credibility gap made it politically impossible for Nixon to maintain large-scale US ground involvement. *Therefore, domestic political unrest was a decisive cause of why US involvement in the Vietnam War changed under President Nixon because it forced the administration to accelerate troop withdrawals to prevent political collapse at home.*

"A third reason why US involvement in the Vietnam War changed under President Nixon was that Nixon shifted the military focus toward aggressive air campaigns." Nixon ordered the invasion of neutral Cambodia in 1970 and Laos in 1971, and launched Operation **Linebacker** bombings on Hanoi. These operations aimed to disrupt the Ho Chi Minh Trail and force North Vietnam to negotiate, protecting withdrawing US forces. *Therefore, this military shift to air campaigns was a key cause of why US involvement in the Vietnam War changed under President Nixon because it replaced American ground combat casualties with heavy air power and regional incursions.*

Question 3(a): Source Utility (8 Marks)

Target: AO3 (8 marks). Assess content utility, verify with contextual knowledge, and evaluate provenance reliability and limitations for BOTH sources.

Source B is highly useful for showing the achievement of the Civil Rights Act (1964) as a collaborative success between the federal government and civil rights leaders. The photograph captures President Johnson shaking hands with Martin Luther King Jr. and presenting him with the pen used to sign the bill into law, surrounded by other activists. This utility is supported by my knowledge that the NAACP and SCLC lobbied intensely for the bill, and King's national campaign, including the March on Washington, was instrumental in creating the public pressure that enabled Johnson to push the act through Congress. The provenance of a photograph published on the front pages of national newspapers in July 1964 makes the source highly useful for demonstrating how this historic milestone was presented to the public, symbolizing a unified, official victory for racial justice. However, it is limited because it is a staged publicity event that conceals the deep political resistance from Southern Democrats and the fact that the Act did not immediately resolve voting disenfranchisement.

Source C is highly useful for showing the direct correlation between non-violent protests in Selma and the passage of the Voting Rights Act of 1965. John Lewis describes being brutally attacked by Alabama state police on 'Bloody Sunday', and notes how this violence shocked President Johnson into introducing the bill to Congress, culminating in a triumphant march of 25,000 people to Montgomery. This content is highly useful because it is supported by my knowledge that the national outrage over the police brutality at the Edmund Pettus Bridge forced federal action, leading Johnson to deliver his 'We Shall Overcome' speech and pass the Voting Rights Act of 1965. The provenance of a first-hand radio interview in 2009 by John Lewis, who was a leading activist at the scene, increases its utility by providing a direct, personal account of the physical sacrifice and strategic success of the marchers. However, as an interview recorded over 40 years later, it may reflect a polished, commemorative reflection of the event's history rather than the immediate tension and fear felt by the participants in 1965.

Question 3(b): Difference Between Interpretations (4 Marks)

Target: AO4 (4 marks). Identify the main difference of view, supported by details from both interpretations.

The main difference is that Interpretation 1 argues that the Civil Rights Act of 1964 was the primary achievement of the movement, describing it as **"one of the most comprehensive pieces of legislation"** because it banned segregation. In contrast, Interpretation 2 argues that the Voting Rights Act of 1965 was the **"transformative milestone"** because it ended the Jim Crow era by banning literacy tests.

Question 3(c): Reason for Difference in Interpretations (4 Marks)

Target: AO4 (4 marks). Explain how the historians may have relied on different sources to reach their views.

The interpretations differ because the historians have given weight to different sources. Interpretation 1 is supported by Source B, which shows President Johnson presenting a pen to Martin Luther King Jr., leading to the view that the Civil Rights Act of 1964 was **"one of the most comprehensive pieces of legislation"**. Conversely, Interpretation 2 is supported by Source C, which details how the marchers on the bridge forced the government's hand, leading to the view that the Voting Rights Act of 1965 was the **"transformative milestone"**.

Question 3(d): Evaluation of Interpretation (16 Marks + 4 SPaG)

Target: AO4 (16 marks) + SPaG (4 marks). Level 4 (13–16 marks): Balanced discussion analyzing both interpretations with sustained contextual knowledge, leading to a justified judgment.

I agree to a large extent with Interpretation 2 that the Voting Rights Act of 1965 was the movement's greatest achievement. My own knowledge confirms that the Act banned the arbitrary **literacy tests** used to exclude Black voters, and sent federal registrars to the South. This transformed the political landscape: in Mississippi, Black registration surged from under **7%** in 1964 to over **59%** by 1968, which ended the total political exclusion of Jim Crow. This supports Interpretation 2's argument that the Act was a **"transformative milestone"** that **"dismantled the political structures of Jim Crow"**.

However, Interpretation 1 is also valid in identifying the immense significance of the Civil Rights Act of 1964. As shown in Source B, this landmark bill was signed following intense pressure, including the **March on Washington**. The Act banned segregation in public accommodations and outlawed discrimination in employment, establishing the principle of federal protection. It also empowered the federal government to **withhold funding** from segregated state programs, which successfully pressured Southern states to comply. This matches Interpretation 1's view that the 1964 Act was **"one of the most comprehensive pieces of legislation"** in US history.

Overall, while the 1964 Act was a massive victory for social desegregation, the 1965 Voting Rights Act was the ultimate achievement because it gave Black Americans the political power to defend their rights. Without the vote, the social gains of 1964 could not be legally enforced or protected at the local level.